Tiny Habits: A Reset Companion

A companion to Day 8 of RESET, a regenerative retreat by Riptide.

Why small

Lasting change grows from small, steady acts, not from willpower. A habit that takes thirty seconds can be planted today, on a busy day, on a tired day, and still grow.

We often begin with the whole tree in mind: run every morning, meditate for an hour, never look at the phone in bed. Then life gets in the way and the plan falls. A tiny habit asks for so little that there is nothing to fall from.

Over the next pages you will choose one change you would like to see, shrink it to its smallest form, and give it a place to grow in your day. Keep your RESET journal close.

Soil, Seed, Sun

Every tiny habit has three parts. Get all three in place and the habit has what it needs to take root.

Part	What it is	Example
Soil	Something you already do every day, without thinking. This is where the new habit is planted.	Putting the kettle on
Seed	The new action, made as small as it can be. It should take under 30 seconds.	Take three slow breaths
Sun	A small moment of warmth straight after, so the habit feels good and wants to grow.	A smile, a quiet "there"

Put together, a tiny habit reads as one line:

After I **[soil]**, *I will* **[seed]**. *Then I* **[sun]**.

After I put the kettle on, I will take three slow breaths. Then I smile.

Planting your habit

Allow ten quiet minutes and your journal. Work through these steps in order.

1. **Name the change you would like to see.** Look back at the intention you set on Day 4. Write it as a feeling or a state, not a task: *calmer mornings*, *more time to create*, *deeper sleep*.
2. **Scatter as many seeds as you can.** List every small action that could move you towards it. Don't judge them yet. Aim for at least ten.
3. **Choose the ones that matter and feel easy.** Circle two or three that would make a real difference and that you could start tomorrow without effort.
4. **Make each one tiny.** Shrink it until it takes less than 30 seconds. *Read for an hour* becomes *open the book*. *Stretch every morning* becomes *one long reach to the ceiling*.
5. **Find its soil.** Pair each seed with something you already do daily, and decide exactly where it follows.
6. **Plan its sun.** Choose how you will mark the moment, however small, the instant it's done.
7. **Write the line.** *After I…, I will…. Then I…* Put it somewhere you will see it, next to your affirmations from Day 7.

Soil, seeds and sun to choose from

Good soil: moments you already have

The best soil is a moment that happens every day, at a steady time, and has a clear end.

Morning	Daytime	Evening
I switch off my alarm	I sit down at my desk	I close my laptop
My feet touch the floor	I put the kettle on	I walk through my front door
I open the curtains	I wash my hands	I finish washing up
I pour my first drink	I sit on the bus or train	I brush my teeth
I lock the front door	I finish a phone call	My head touches the pillow

Shrinking a seed

If a habit takes more than 30 seconds, or you find yourself putting it off, make it smaller. Do the first step only, do one of something instead of many, or simply get things ready.

Too big to start	Tiny seed
Write in my journal every day	Write one line

Too big to start	Tiny seed
Go for a run	Put on my running shoes
Meditate for 20 minutes	Close my eyes for three breaths
Drink more water	Fill one glass
Read before bed	Read one page

Once a seed has taken root you may find yourself doing more without trying. Let it grow at its own pace.

Feeling the sun

The moment of warmth is what tells the habit to stay. It should be instant, quick and feel genuine to you.

- A small smile, or a quiet "there" or "done"
- A slow out-breath, letting the shoulders drop
- A hand on the heart
- Looking out of the window for a moment
- A nod to yourself in the mirror
- Picturing the seed you planted on Day 1, a little taller

Tiny habits to try

Borrow any of these as they are, or use them as a starting point for your own.

For reducing stress

After I…	I will…
put the kettle on	take three slow breaths while it boils
sit down in the car or on the train	drop my shoulders and unclench my jaw
finish a phone call	look at something green for a moment
feel my heart rate rise	place a hand on my chest and breathe out slowly
walk through my front door	say "I'm home" out loud

For increasing focus

After I…	I will…
sit down at my desk	write the one thing that matters most today
open my laptop	close every tab I don't need
finish a task	stand up and stretch once before the next
pick up my phone without meaning to	put it face down and take one breath
make my mid-morning drink	step outside for one minute

For better sleep

After I…	I will…
finish my evening meal	dim one light in the house
brush my teeth	put my phone on charge outside the bedroom
get into bed	write one thing I'm grateful for
turn off the light	relax my face, from forehead to jaw
wake in the night	count five slow breaths before checking the time

When a habit doesn't take

A seed that doesn't sprout is information, not failure. Change the conditions, not yourself.

- **You keep forgetting.** The soil may be wrong. Choose a moment that happens more reliably, or one closer to where the habit takes place.
- **You keep putting it off.** The seed is still too big. Shrink it again until it feels almost too easy.
- **It feels like a chore.** The sun is missing. Find a way to mark the moment that genuinely lifts you.
- **It no longer fits your life.** Let it go, as we practised on Day 2, and plant something else.

Tending your habits

Between now and Day 21, note in your journal each evening which habits you watered. There is no score to keep. Simply notice which have rooted, which need a different spot, and which are already growing taller than you planned.

Your planting page

Write up to three tiny habits below.

The change I would like to see: _____

After I… (soil)	I will… (seed)	Then I… (sun)